

Brainstorming

Ideation Phase | Import Data Using Transform Maps

1. Brainstorming Objective

Generate as many ideas as possible for loading external data into ServiceNow accurately and repeatably, then group them into themes before prioritising.

2. Ground Rules

- Quantity first: no idea is rejected during generation.
- Build on others' ideas.
- Stay focused on the problem statement.
- Evaluate only after all ideas are captured.

3. Ideas Generated

#	Idea	Theme
1	Upload CSV/Excel into an import set staging table	Data loading
2	Create a Transform Map to map source columns to target fields	Mapping
3	Use Auto Map Matching Fields to speed up mapping	Mapping
4	Define a coalesce field (e.g. email, serial number) to avoid duplicates	Data quality
5	Use field map scripts to convert values (e.g. Active to true)	Transformation
6	Use reference lookups to link department, location or manager	Transformation
7	Add onBefore script to skip rows with missing required values	Validation
8	Use choice actions to create missing choice values	Transformation
9	Review Transform History and import logs after each run	Monitoring
10	Schedule imports from a data source (e.g. JDBC / file on MID server)	Automation
11	Import into a test instance first, then production	Safety
12	Create a data template with fixed headers for data owners	Process
13	Use REST/SOAP web service import sets for system-to-system loads	Automation
14	Document mappings in a shared mapping sheet	Documentation

4. Grouped Themes

Theme	Ideas	Goal
Data loading	1, 10, 13	Get data into staging reliably
Mapping and transformation	2, 3, 5, 6, 8	Place correct values in correct fields
Data quality and validation	4, 7	Prevent duplicates and bad rows

Theme	Ideas	Goal
Monitoring and safety	9, 11	Detect problems early and reduce risk
Process and documentation	12, 14	Make the approach repeatable

5. Alternatives Considered

Alternative	Reason not chosen as main approach
Manual entry in forms	Slow and error-prone at volume
Direct Excel upload to a list (list import)	No field transformation or coalesce control
Custom scripted imports only	Higher effort and harder to maintain than a Transform Map